

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St. Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



RESIDENTS WARY OF UGD OVER BACKFLOW RISK

Lakshmi Street residents say they have been receiving notices to pay UGD charges despite not taking connections **P3**



CHILDREN SET TO SCRIPT CHANGE

A year-long puppetry production titled "Enge Engal Nadhigal" by Agai — Theatre of Voices has children from a Narikurava community in Pallavaram taking centre stage as storytellers **P6**

Additional opening sought near Radha Nagar subway

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Commuters at Chromepet railway station have requested Southern Railway to provide an additional opening near the Radha Nagar subway to enter platform 1A.

At present, there is no opening except for the one leading to the platforms through tracks till Chromepet railway station haltover (towards MIT flyover).

Commuters and pedestrians from GST Road eastern lane boarding trains from platforms 1A and 2, to buy tickets and access the footbridge, avoid taking a detour to the main entrance; they instead either cross the tracks or navigate a narrow path marked by stones, trash and uneven surfaces.

A. Ramanathan, a commuter, says, "If an opening is facilitated it will prevent pedestrians from crossing the tracks. To reach Station Border Road and avoid taking



This gate below the footbridge at Chromepet railway station should be locked, and an entry facilitated along the staircases of the bridge; and (left) the narrow pathway that pedestrians take.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

a detour and climbing the footbridge, pedestrians cross and walk along the tracks. The opening will help them to access the footbridge."

For pedestrians coming from Station Road, an opening to GST Road would be useful. Likewise for people going to Station Road and Station Border Road.

At present, a section of pedestrians navigate along the halt, in addition to commuters traffic entering and exiting the station.

During rush hour, it would be very tough for commuters and pedestrians to navigate along the halt, on platform 1A and the footbridge.

V. Dharmalingam, a pedestrian, says, "People do not understand the gravity of the situation and after the rains, the path can be really risky. Rather than creating an opening along the footbridge, between the steel boundary railings, a gate, facilitated between the railings, is open to let the pedestrians navigate an unhygienic path."

'Traffic diversion on Radial Road working fine'



The new traffic changes at Vels' University junction on Pallavaram - Thorai-pakkam 200-Foot Radial Road seems to be working fine, at least for the last few days since it was implemented.

The junction has been barri-

caded and is out of bounds for vehicular traffic.

As per the traffic diversion introduced by T3 Pallavaram Traffic Police, motorists from Zamin Pallavaram can take a u-turn along the junction (opposite a timber depot).

Similarly, motorists from P V Vaithalingam Road, Pallavaram, to go to Taluk Office Road can take a u-turn.

Motorists from Taluk Office Road, to go to P V Vaithalingam Road, have to take a U-turn near Ganapathipuram in Chromepet.

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‘Deliver the goods before seeking charges’

Lakshmi Street residents in Hasthinapuram say they have been receiving notices to pay UGD charges despite not taking connections; seek redesign of drainage alignment

T. ARVIND

Residents of Lakshmi Street in Saraswathi Colony, Hasthinapuram, have not opted for underground drainage (UGD) connections, saying they would do so only after the Tambaram Corporation assures them that sewage will not flow back into their homes. They also say they have received SMSes asking them to pay UGD charges despite not having taken household connections.

The UGD scheme was implemented in Chromepet around 2010-11 by the then Pallavaram Municipality, now part of the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation. While complaints of sewage overflow at several locations have surfaced over the years, residents say the problem affecting a section of Lakshmi Street is different.

According to them, the inspection chamber serving houses on the northern side of the street remains filled almost to the brim with sewage even though many households have not been connected to the UGD network. Fearing that sewage could flow back into their premises because of the alignment



Houses on the northern side of Lakshmi Street in Saraswathi Colony, Hasthinapuram. PHOTO: T. ARVIND

of the pipeline, most residents on the northern side have continued to rely on septic tanks, except one newly constructed apartment which has a UGD connection.

P.K. Ravi, a long-time resident, said the issue had been repeatedly taken up with Corporation officials and elected representatives.

“We continue to depend on septic tanks, which has to be emptied periodically. Yet we have received SMSes asking us to pay UGD charges even though we have not taken connections,” he said.

Pointing to the street's gradient, Ravi alleged that the alignment of the sewer line was flawed.

“The road slopes from west to east, while the sewer line has been designed to carry sewage from east to west. This is why we fear sewage

could flow back into our homes if we take connections,” he said.

Trial and redesign

Kannaiyan, another resident and a retired government employee, said residents were not opposed to joining the UGD scheme but wanted the Corporation to address their concerns first. “We are willing to take UGD connections, but officials should first demonstrate that sewage will not return to our houses. They should conduct a trial and dispel our fears,” he said.

He said the Corporation had laid an additional pipeline above the existing one about three years ago, but the sewage level in the chamber continued to remain high.

“Our houses are at a slightly lower level. We want the Corporation

to redesign the alignment so that the sewage level in the chamber remains well below the surface. Only then will we have the confidence to join the scheme,” Kannaiyan said.

Residents also questioned how the first inspection chamber on their street remained full despite the absence of household connections, alleging that sewage could be flowing in from an adjoining street.

Administrative boundary complicates issue

Residents pointed out that while the northern side of Lakshmi Street falls within Ward 37 of the Tambaram Corporation, the opposite side comes under the Chitlapakkam limits, where the UGD scheme has not yet been implemented, leaving the issue unresolved for one section of the street and likely to affect

the other in future.

When contacted, Ward 37 councillor Mahalakshmi Karunakaran said residents should take up the issue of UGD payment notices with the Corporation Commissioner.

On the alleged design flaw, she said an additional pipeline had been laid in 2023 following residents' representations.

“We have asked residents to try taking connections one by one. If the problem persists, we will rectify it,” she said. However, residents remained unconvinced, saying temporary pumping of sewage would not address the underlying problem.

Call for fresh survey

Another resident suggested that officials should inspect whether the UGD line could instead be connected to the inspection chamber on nearby Varadharajan Street, which is at a lower level. Social activist M. Ravi said the issue could be resolved through a technical reassessment of the drainage network.

“The Corporation Commissioner should direct engineers to survey locations where uneven sewage flow has been reported and allocate funds for redesign wherever necessary,” he said.

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Team from WRD survey **Nattu Kalvai**



For years, the Federation of Thiruneermalai Residents' Welfare Associations has been appealing to the Water Resources Department and Revenue Department to restructure the ‘Nattu Kalvai’ canal – a crucial rainwater channel that carries excess water from the Thiruneermalai

Periya Eri to the Adyar River.

This is to prevent flooding and safeguard the region.

The proposal gained momentum recently, following an inspection by a team of officials from the Water Resources and Revenue (Pallavaram) Departments, who surveyed the canal.

During the inspection, the team (*in picture*) identified buildings every 100 metres, with each structure marking the canal area for two to three metres.

B. Saravanan, the treasurer of the Federation, recommended creating a slope at locations where buildings have reduced the canal's width and increasing the canal's depth to keep flooding at bay.

Exploring the feasibility of a closed canal should also be looked into, he suggested.

“A sum of ₹44 crore has been sanctioned for the canal's restoration. It is now for Pallavaram MLA J. Kamatchi to raise this issue with N. Anand, State Minister for Water Resources, during the upcoming Assembly budget session to secure the allocation of the mentioned fund as this issue has been dragging on for the last 11 years.”

Text: T.S. Atul Swaminathan

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Exploration of green campuses in Chennai soon

With a pan-India initiative by Nature Conservation Foundation inviting colleges to create a Campus Biodiversity Register, one can find lists from institutions such as MCC, IIT-M, WCC and Stella Maris making it to iNaturalist, eBird and Season Watch



The sylvan MCC campus.

LIFY THOMAS

The backyard of certain college campuses hardly resemble backyards as we usually understand them: a poky little space, lacklustre, hardly hoofed by human feet. In these colleges, the backyard is an expansive space, supporting an incredible population of furs and feathers; and they pull in human feet given to exploration and documentation of biodiversity.

Classic examples include IIT Madras in Guindy and Madras Christian College in Tambaram. There are also others such as Women's Christian College in Nungambakkam and Stella Maris College in Gopalapuram that lend themselves to making of biodiversity checklists.

Against this green backdrop, Campus Biodiversity Register (CBS) is hugely relevant to Chennai. CBS invites colleges and universities to discover and document the biodiversity on their campuses and build a lasting record of it. An initiative of the Nature on Campus team of the Nature Conservation Foundation (NCF) together with the National Biodiversity Authority, Government of India, the nationwide year-long initiative seeks that students and faculty document biodiversity on their campuses using three citizen science platforms – iNaturalist, eBird and SeasonWatch. WCC, Stella Maris and MCC have doc-

umented the flora, avifauna and fauna on their campuses in the past and brought books on them. From some colleges, the books have also opened their pages to insects. Students of the BSc in Environmental Science and Sustainability and teachers at Azim Premji University in Bengaluru brought out a Campus Biodiversity Register 2024-25 that can be accessed online.

CBR expects these institutions to document their biodiversity with conservation in mind, sustaining endangered species. Besides gaining hands-on experience observing, identifying and documenting species, the participating institutions would be contributing to a global database with their inputs. According to a note on campusbiodiversity.in, by participating one is contributing valuable biodiversity information to global databases as envisioned by the Convention on Biological Diversity while complementing the efforts of the People's Biodiversity Register. The project encourages institutions with just standalone buildings to also sign up for the exercise as biodiversity can be found in the most unexpected places.

There is no fee to participate in this project. Registrations are open till November 2026.

For more details, visit <https://campusbiodiversity.in> or email natureoncampus@ncf-india.org

(MVBB), based in Gopalapuram and run by TTK Group as a service to society, and whenever he receives a call-up from them, he is in attendance at that address the next moment. In April this year, MVBB celebrated its Golden Jubilee.

Shamsudeen elaborates: "As I have a rare blood type, I do not donate blood once in three to four months as many donors do, but donate when there is an emergency, an urgent need for AB Negative. MVBB keeps a record of when I donated blood, and in an emergency, they would call me if I am within the date for donating blood again."

Bookmark this thought: irrespective of whether one's blood group is rare or common, one would do well to be attached to a blood donation organisation so that one gets tuned in to the idea of donating blood as often as they can by virtue of getting timely reminders and urgent call-ups.

Shamsudeen's blood donation tally stands at 22.

As he desired, Shamsudeen's journey as a blood donor has followed the same trajectory as his father's.

(Before preceeding with the how of it, a snapshot of a recent ho-

If you are gripped by a mission to increase the numbers of blood donors, but do not know where to begin, begin at home. Have conversations with your children about your blood donation journey. It sure works: ask the Shaikhs

A leitmotif among blood donation organisations is the increasing difficulty in finding people with "generous veins"; and the solution could strangely be found in the living rooms of households, as illustrated by these two accounts from Chennai of parents inspiring their children to join the cause

Create blood donors at home

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN



Shaikh Shamsudeen and Shaikh Sadaqathullah

nour to the father-son duo. Last month, on World Blood Donors Day, Crescent Blood Donors honoured Shaikh Sadaqathullah and his son Shaikh Shamsudeen for their commitment to blood donation at an event organised at Kavikko Convention Centre in Mylapore. The award was jointly presented by noted film director Ameer Sultan and Ahmed Buhari, trustee of B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science & Technology)

Besides the commitment to donating blood as often they can and the choice to be attached to MVBB, father and son share their blood type, AB Negative. The blood donation tally of Shaikh Sadaqathullah, 56 years old, stands at 53. As Sadaqathullah notes, a tinge of disappointment slipping into his voice for a fleeting moment, he stopped donating blood due to health concerns.

(A trivia: Sadaqathullah is an amateur radio operator and his call sign is VU2SDU)

Sadaqathullah's blood donation journey was initiated at the Perambur Railway Hospital in 1993 where he donated blood responding to a friend's call. "It was then I realised that my blood group was rare. Any negative blood type is considered rare, and AB Negative is rare even among the negative blood types. Globally, 2 per cent of the population has this blood type. Given this, I have not donated at blood donation camps, only when there was an emergency need for AB Negative, and MVBB would call him."

The interviews were with the father and son duo were conducted separately, and what struck was the similarity not only in the language they used, but also the sentiments they expressed.

There is a lesson there, and probably hope too, for blood donation champions such as Srivatsa Vema from the Federation of Indian Blood Donors Organisation (FIBDO) who has expressed concern over a decreasing number of blood donors.

Bookmark this thought too: if you gripped by a mission to increase the numbers of blood donors, but do not know where to begin, begin at home. Have conversations with your children about your blood donation journey. It sure works: ask the Shaikhs.

COLLECTIVE KINDNESS is a column about efforts by voluntary agencies and individual volunteers to shore up processes by public and private enterprises aimed at bringing personal well-being to people

Get started

There are many organisations that drive blood donation on an everyday basis and also through campaigns. Here are some organisations that can help one get started on blood donation.

- Rotary Central TTK VHS Blood Bank being run at Voluntary Health Services (VHS) in Tharamani. Contact: 044-22542829
- Madras Voluntary Blood Bank (MVBB) at 6, Cathedral Road in Gopalapuram, organises blood donations for people in need, connecting donors with those who need blood. Contact: 9841821997/ 9094039538 / 044-28111403 (Saturday and Sunday are off days)
- Crescent Blood Donors at Crescent college campus in Vandalur. Though located at an institution, outsiders can also donate blood after being screened; the group can be contacted for blood donation needs too. Contact: 9087410874
- Through blood donation drives, New College supports blood bank at government hospitals as well as individuals looking for blood donors. The college does not have a dedicated blood bank, but its administrative office can be contacted at 044-28351269/ 28350386
- For donating blood and to receive blood as donation, contact Federation of Indian Blood Donors at 9381005254
- Direction for Volunteers (D4V) conducts blood donation drives and its efforts help medical establishments such as Voluntary Health Services and Institute of Child Health. For details, WhatsApp D4V at 7448888065
- Lions Blood Bank & Research Foundation is located at 130, Marshalls Road in Egmore. For details, call 044-28414949

A family tradition



R. Ravikumar donating blood on March 17, 2026 for the 106th time.

Nanganallur resident R. Ravikumar would not skip certain schedules, some day-based and others occurring every few months, not for all the tea in China. These schedules largely relate to his passion for cycling, running and donating blood. The unwavering commitment to blood donation has put an enviable tally against his name: 106 blood donations, the last donation made on March 17, 2026 at Sunrays Hospital in Ashok Nagar.

Ravikumar, a retired manager from the Oriental Insurance Company Limited, has never viewed blood donation as a mere act of charity. It has been a family legacy, a service that brings him closer to his father's memory: his father was a blood donor, having donated over 50 times in his lifetime. And Ravikumar traces his iron-clad commitment to blood donation to his late father S. Rengarajan's example as well as simple philosophy, which drives his world view. "Even if we cannot help someone financially, we can always serve the society through our actions without expecting anything in return," his father would often say. Inspired by those words, Ravikumar (whose blood type is B Positive) began do-

nating blood at the age of 23 in 1984, the first donation aimed at helping a colleague's wife who was undergoing surgery. To continue this service, Ravikumar has made staying healthy his top priority through regular marathon runs and long distance cycling, believing physical fitness is the reason that he is still able to answer every call for blood.

Since the age of 56, he has participated in numerous endurance events, earning 85 medals. He is also an active member of several blood donation groups in Chennai, continuing to respond to urgent need for donors.

Among the 106 donations, one will always remain etched in his memory. In 2019, after donating blood for a six-year-old cancer patient from Odisha, the child's parents insisted on meeting him. "I told them I had done nothing special, but they still wanted to thank me," he recalls.

The scene that followed will make anyone go teary-eyed. They bowed in gratitude, a gesture that deeply moved him and reaffirmed his belief that compassion knows no language.

While Ravikumar's father donated blood over 50 times, and today his brother R. Ramesh has crossed 60 donations.

What began as one man's quiet belief in selfless service has now grown into a powerful family tradition.

The list of hospitals Ravikumar has donated to include Apollo Hospital in Greams Road, Nandanam Apollo Cancer Speciality Hospital, Vijaya Hospital, Miot Hospital, Egmore Children's Hospital, Adyar Cancer Institute, VHS Blood Bank, various Rotary Club camps, Railway Hospital in Perambur, Sevayala in Thirunindravoor, SIMS Hospital, Chrompet Government Hospital, Rajaji Government Hospital, Sunrays Hospital and WCCG blood donation camps.

Ravikumar is 65 years old now, usually considered the maximum age at which one could donate blood. Exceptions to that rule do exist; and Ravikumar seems set to be an exception.

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Want to understand your city? Try travelling from one end of it to the other. On July 18, fifteen children from the Narikurava community in Pallavaram had the privilege of doing that kind of cross-city travel thanks to "Toxic Tour" organised by Agai - Theatre of Voices in collaboration with Vettiver Collective and Chennai Climate Action Group. These children were being introduced to the industrial north of Chennai where tall chimneys mark the skyline. For the first time, they were setting eyes on thermal power plants, oil refineries and the Adani Port.

At every turn, the children learnt how development was impacting people's everyday lives; more specifically, breathing polluted, toxic air into those lives. This was no awareness tour. The children were wearing the researcher's hat, filing away information for Enge Engal Nadhigal (Where Are Our Rivers?), a year-long puppetry production that has children taking centre stage as storytellers, writing their own scripts.

Architect of this initiative, Agai - Theatre of Voices is a young Gen-Z Chennai collective that seeks to provide a collaborative platform for their own (that is, other members of Gen Z) to work towards social and environmental justice. The philosophy is hardly accidental. It mirrors the journeys of its founders, Tittu (as he prefers to be known) and Nambi Srinivas, both trained social workers whose paths first crossed at the Madras School of Social Work. While Tittu went on to pursue a postgraduate degree at Christ University, Bengaluru and Nambi specialised in community development, theatre became the language that united them long before Agai formally came into existence in 2023. For Tittu, social work dismantled not only career choices, but inherited beliefs. For one, "it made me question the idea that we have to speak for commun-



Children set to *script change*

A year-long puppetry production titled "Enge Engal Nadhigal" by Agai - Theatre of Voices has children from a Narikurava community in Pallavaram taking centre stage as storytellers. As part of this initiative, the children were taken on a tour of the industrial north Chennai on July 18 to understand the negative impact development can have on people's everyday lives and bring that insight into their stories

ities." That conviction deepened after Tittu was selected for Kanthari, the international leadership programme in Thiruvananthapuram, where he was among only three participants from India. There, meeting Sabriye Tenberken, founder of the first blind school in Tibet, re-moulded Agai's ideological compass. "We completely reject the phrase 'voice of the voiceless'," he says. "Everyone already has a voice. What people need is someone willing to listen." And that is Agai's guiding principle now, one informing its initiatives including the programme for the children from the Narikurava community in

The spirit of collaboration

Agai - Theatre of Voices works alongside organisations such as Vettiver Collective, Chennai Climate Action Group and Open House, sharing skills, resources and campaigns rather than guarding ownership.

It is also one of the organisations behind March for Marshlands, a rally scheduled for July 25 at Besant Nagar Beach. Bringing together more than 20 organisations and citizens across Chennai, the rally calls for the conservation of the city's marshlands and stronger action against encroachments and ecologically unsound construction projects, particularly the proposed Mammalam Reservoir project.

Agai also runs a tribal education programme in the Nilgiris, supports digital comics on child rights, operates the Agai Stellar Band that produces music around environmental themes, and conducts youth outreach programmes that introduce urban students to tribal communities through shared experiences instead of surveys and statistics.

Pallavaram.

Again has been working with these children for two months now. No rigid lesson plans; not compulsory practice sessions. Much of the time has simply been spent sitting with the children, making puppets and just talking. Only after that comfort began to emerge did stories begin to surface.

"Once we gave them the puppets, they started speaking automatically," recalls Tittu. "Nothing was prompted. We did not expect it. One child spoke about forests. Another spoke about the River Ganga, even though she has never seen it. The puppets became a space where they could say things adults never asked them."

Those stories will eventually become Enge Engal Nadhigal. Over the coming year, the children themselves will shape the script, perform it and later travel to different parts of Chennai, and eventually other cities using theatre to tell audiences about disappearing rivers, environmental degradation and the worlds they inhabit.

The process matters as much as the performance. "Getting children to stay with us for even one hour is difficult," says Tittu. "One place they do not want to go is school. So we do not recreate school. We do not ask them to sit quietly and listen." Instead, Agai asks adults to do something considerably harder: to listen.

Says Srinivas: "We are simply doing small things and going with the flow." That "flow" has become Agai's operational term.

For Srinivas Nambi and Tittu, going with the flow would mean creating "a forest-based learning space where children enjoy education. We do not want them to adapt to a system. We want to build a system that grows with them." Part of that would be photography programmes, football coaching for tribal youth and creative learning rooted in local knowledge rather than imposed ideas. It is an ambitious vision for a collective that admits financial uncertainty remains its greatest challenge.



During one of the sessions.

Vel's Institute of Science, Technology and Advanced Studies (VISTAS) opened an Artificial Intelligence (AI) vertical university campus on East Coast Road.

Sridhar Vembu, chief scientist and co-founder of Zoho Corporation, inaugurated the campus in the presence of Ishari K. Ganesh, chancellor, Vel's University, and Ahmed Mir Hashim Khoori, a board member of the Emirates Airline Foundation.

The campus features AI-enabled classrooms, smart learning systems, advanced laboratories, innovation studios, collaborative learning spaces, and digital libraries.

A major highlight of the campus is its Industry-Academia Centres of Excellence, established in collaboration with Intel Unnati, TCS iON, Microsoft, and Oracle Academy, which will provide students with hands-on exposure to AI, cloud computing, high-perfor-



▼ A MoU was signed between Vel's University and Dubai Airlines Group for aviation training. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

He encouraged students to develop deep technical expertise, embrace lifelong learning, solve real-world problems through innovation, and contribute meaningfully to India's technological advancement.

A Memorandum of Understanding was signed between Vel's University and the Dubai Airlines Group for aviation training, internships, faculty exchange, skill development, and international career opportunities for students.

The varsity will also soon sign an MoU with Zoho Corporation to collaborate in Artificial Intelligence, emerging technologies, research, innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, and industry-academia initiatives, added the release.

VISTAS opens AI varsity

mance computing, and other emerging technologies.

Delivering the inaugural address, Sridhar Vembu appreciated

the vision behind the new campus and emphasised the importance of building indigenous technologies.

Building a secure financial future

S. Ramalingam (*in picture*), an insurance advisor and mutual fund distributor, believes a secure financial future rests on four essential pillars: term insurance, health insurance, systematic investment plans, and systematic withdrawal plans (SWPs).

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certified Mutual Fund Distributor, he has helped individuals and families

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Debut exhibition of young artist

Every artist remembers the moment when a blank canvas became a world of endless possibilities.

For young artist Semmozhi Navaladi Raja that moment has blossomed into a solo art exhibition titled 'Genesis - Debut Collection'.

The paintings are not just colours, but hours of observation, imagination, patience, and perseverance.



Semmozhi has chosen to express her thoughts and emotions through art, drawing in-

spiration from serene landscapes and natural wonders.

The exhibition can be viewed on July 19 at Art Cube Gallery, Second Street, Elango Nagar, Virugambakkam, from 10 a.m. to 9 p.m.

The exhibition marks the beginning of a young artist's journey and is the result of the support of her family members and mentors, said a release.

The exhibition also features works celebrating India's rich artistic heritage.



Inter-school quiz competition

Union Christian Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Chetpet will be hosting the 19th edition of its Inter School Quiz Competition 'InQuizitive' for students of classes IX to XII on July 24. Calling all Chennai schools to register using the QR Code on or before July 21, 2026

Exhibition of silk saris

D. Ravi Silks is holding a silk expo at Kanchi Residency, Anna Nagar, featuring exquisite silk saris combining authenticity and quality.

D Ravi began his career in 1987 as a weaver. Later, he started a small enterprise with six weavers at his home. In 1998, he opened a store in Kancheepuram.

The showroom designs and weaves a variety of Kan-

cheepuram silk saris, with traditional designs inspired by Kancheepuram's temples and the dreams of present-generation women.

The saris woven by more than 250 weavers reflect timeless elegance, exceptional craftsmanship, and the rich heritage of Kancheepuram silk, said a release.

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